have come forward in supporting India's neighbours in infrastructural projects to minimise the Chinese presence in the region.[31]

Japan has made a firm commitment to work with India in South Asian development cooperation. At the end of the annual Prime Ministerial summit in Tokyo in October 2018, Modi and Abe issued a vision statement, saying:

> The two Prime Ministers reviewed with satisfaction the cooperation on development of connectivity via quality infrastructure, and other projects including capacity building for shared prosperity, carried out bilaterally and with other partners, in an open, transparent and non-exclusive manner and based on international standards, responsible debt financing practices, and in alignment with local economic and development strategies and priorities. This synergy is embodied in collaborative projects between India and Japan in the Indo-Pacific region, including in Sri Lanka, Myanmar and Bangladesh as well as in Africa. In this regard, the two Prime Ministers welcomed the discussions for establishing the "Platform for Japan-India Business Cooperation in Asia-Africa Region" to further enhance the exchanges between Japanese and Indian businesses toward developing industrial corridors and industrial network in the region.
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> *(para 4)* [32]

India and Japan had started working together in third countries even before this formal commitment. In May 2017, they had joined hands to develop liquefied natural gas (LNG) import terminals in Sri Lanka for two power plants of 500 MW capacity each. It may be interesting to note that Sri Lanka had also engaged China in this sector for a 400-MW plant. India's then–Foreign Secretary Jaishankar had also indicated at a conference in July 2018 that India was exploring the possibility of collaborating with Japan for the development of Trincomalee harbour in eastern Sri Lanka. This trilateral cooperation also extended to defence as well as scientific and industrial research areas. Indo–Japan cooperation for the development of India's northeast, through the Indo–Japan Act East Forum, has undertaken road connectivity projects with the support of the Asian